



ITALIANS

CUSTODIANS OF AN ANCIENT LEGACY

THE COUNTRY WE KNOW AS ITALY only came into existence in 1861, around the same time as a widespread knowledge of the national language, Tuscan Italian, began to take root. Even today people still feel a strong

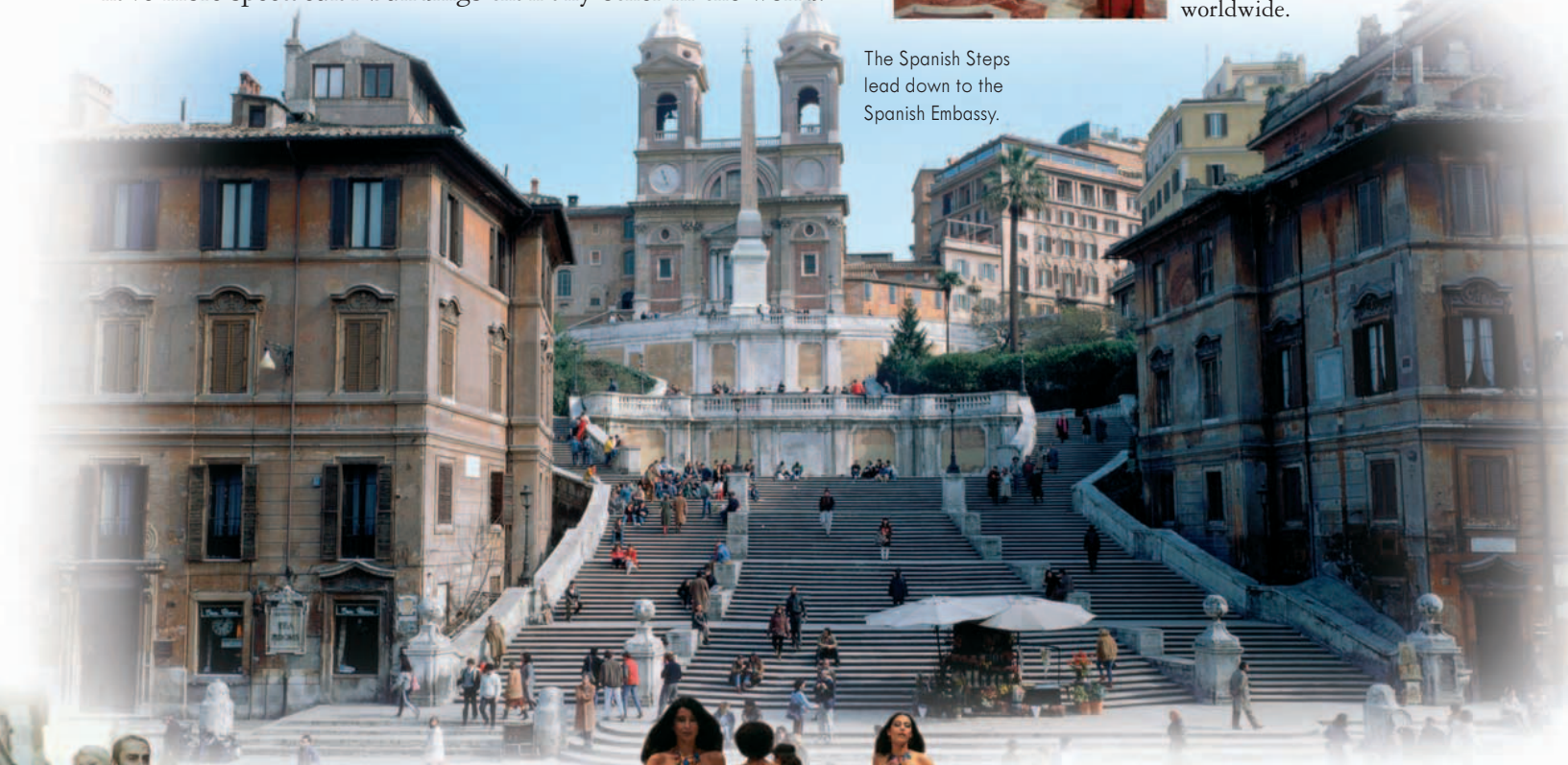
Rome wasn't built in a day

Italy's capital, Rome, is known as the Eternal City due to its long history. Legend has it that Rome was founded by twin brothers named Romulus and Remus around 753 BC. Many civilizations have left their mark on the city, which is said to have more spectacular buildings than any other in the world.



CITY WITHIN A CITY
Vatican City has the status of a country, but it lies entirely within Rome. It is officially governed by the Pope, who is also the religious leader of one billion Catholics worldwide.

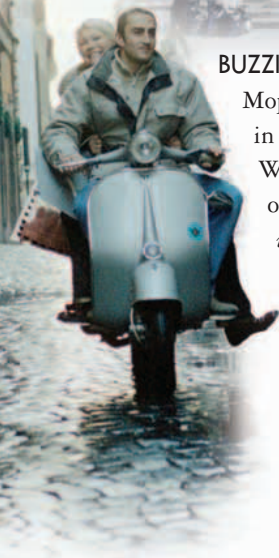
The Spanish Steps lead down to the Spanish Embassy.



BUZZING AROUND

Mopeds became popular in Italy after World War II with the creation of the curvy yet robust *vespa* ("wasp"). They were easier to ride than cars on bomb-damaged roads.

Mopeds are slower and less powerful than motorcycles.



CHIC TAILORING

Stylish clothes are a matter of honor for almost all Italians. Italy's fashion industry is among the most famous in the world. It is an important part of the economy and employs one million people.

CAR INDUSTRY

Turin is the center of the Italian motor industry. Giovanni Agnelli founded a car factory here in 1899, which later became the Fiat factory. Other companies have sprung up alongside it that design and manufacture car components.

